

Benjamin Smarjesse

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IT Support Specialist | Help Desk Technician

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Technical Troubleshooting
- Hardware Installation
- Network Diagnostics
- Customer Service and Support
- Remote Desktop Support
- Ticketing System Management
- Team Collaboration
- Software Configuration
- IT Security Awareness

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Help Desk Specialist | CBIZ | May 2025– Present

- Provided technical support to Edward Jones branches, home offices, and field associates by resolving hardware, software, and network issues; supported Windows operating systems, proprietary financial applications, and remote connectivity to maintain business continuity.
- Administered and troubleshot Microsoft 365 applications, including Outlook, Teams, OneDrive, and SharePoint, to improve collaboration and productivity; managed incidents in ServiceNow by documenting, prioritizing, and escalating tickets in alignment with ITIL best practices and company SLAs.
- Leveraged ServiceNow reporting and knowledge base tools to streamline processes and improve resolution efficiency; delivered exceptional customer service through active listening, clear communication, and thorough follow-up to ensure issue resolution.

Help Desk Specialist | STRATEGIC SOLUTIONS INC | SEPTEMBER 2024 – May 2025

- Managed user queries via phone, email, delivering tailored support and professional guidance to resolve technical issues across hardware, software, and network systems; ensured seamless resolution of 88%+ cases at first touch to minimize downtime and enhance end-user productivity.
- Diagnosed and troubleshot complex system failures by leveraging expertise in Microsoft 365, Citrix Active Roles, and proprietary software; escalated advanced issues to Tier 2 support, ensuring prompt action and seamless alignment with IT service protocols.
- Streamlined resolution processes by documenting common issues and solutions, creating a robust knowledge base used by team members; drove consistency and reduced resolution time for recurring issues, improving team efficiency.

Yard Spotter | ABF FREIGHT SYSTEM | JUNE 2014 – SEPTEMBER 2024

- Expertly maneuvered and positioned trailers to support seamless yard operations, meeting tight delivery schedules without delays; implemented best practices to minimize operational bottlenecks and enhance logistical coordination with dispatch teams.
- Worked with logistics and loading teams to execute timely operations, ensuring that trailers were strategically placed to optimize loading efficiency and reduce turnaround times; elevated yard productivity while maintaining adherence to safety protocols.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Bachelor's in information technology, Governor State University, 2025

- ✓ Member Of National Society of Collegiate Scholars and Tau Sigma

Associate's in applied science, Computer Information Systems, (Programming Option), Joliet Junior College, 2019

- ✓ Member Of Phi Theta Kappa and National Society of Collegiate Scholars

High School Diploma, Momence High School, 2007

IT SKILLS

Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, Outlook, PowerPoint), Linux, CLI, Wireshark, Packet Tracer

LICENSURE AND CERTIFICATION

- Google IT Support Certificate 2022
- CompTIA A+ R7KQX49QQJB1QC5W
- Netacad Network Basics and Netacad CCNA
- CompTIA ITF+ 2023

PROJECTS

ENTERPRISE ACTIVE DIRECTORY SECURITY HOMELAB PROJECT

Designed and deployed a virtualized enterprise identity infrastructure using Microsoft Hyper-V to simulate real-world corporate Active Directory environments.

Key components implemented:

Designed enterprise AD environment using Hyper-V virtualization

- Implemented multi-domain controller architecture with DNS replication
- Built RBAC security model using Active Directory groups
- Deployed Windows LAPS for automated credential management
- Implemented Enterprise PKI using Active Directory Certificate Services
- Designed Tiered Administration Model (Tier0 / Tier1 / Tier2)
- Configured security auditing to monitor privileged group changes
- Integrated hybrid identity with Microsoft Entra ID